



Credit: starwars.com

The computer generated CGI set, called "The Volume" used for filming The Mandalorian.

they're not subjected to any oversight, and are "improved" solely to make the parent company more money... then you begin to understand why they push us all in one direction.

MOVIES

While movies might be just as popular or even more popular and more accessible than ever before, thanks to streaming services, we can't help feel that the quality of movies being put out has fallen drastically in many ways.

To begin with, computer generated imagery (CGI) has reached the point where it is so cheap and so omnipresent that more and more of movie scenes are just being painted in. The green screen (or blue, or whatever) is just a standard set prop now, as are the suits with motion capture dots and more. Showing off all of this CGI prowess usually results in everything being unreal and so many movies being set in fantasy or fictional worlds. Now with every third flick being about science fiction, space or fantasy, we seem to be telling less and less of human stories, which are relatable and real. Of course, that's just our opinion, and maybe you love all the movies that are being released now.

There used to be a time when we thought the Internet would kill off movies because of piracy, and if we're

honest, some of us in Team Digit always felt that entertainment should be free to those who cannot afford it, and in a weird way, we were actually OK with piracy. There could be a million reasons why people could not afford to pay for movies, and in a world increasingly driven by tech culture, you cannot really fault them for having a little FOMO. We were always opposed to the calculations the MPAA and others would do to arrive at exorbitant figures of the amount of losses they suffered because of piracy, because there's no way of knowing how many of those people would pay to watch movies if they couldn't pirate. Maybe most of them would just end up watching something else that was free, or stick to the old movies on TV if piracy doesn't exist. In fact, just as piracy of Windows and MS Office used to help Microsoft retain a stranglehold on PCs back in the day, some of us felt that movie piracy is what kept Hollywood relevant across the globe, and only built up the demand even more for their movies.

While people were focussed on piracy killing movies, streaming services with their ridiculously cheap prices and large volume of serialised content came along and did that anyway. For hundreds of millions of people across the globe, the COVID pandemic didn't really change their

movie or video content consuming experience. Whether it was on OTT services like Netflix, Disney+, Hulu, Amazon Prime Video and others (depending on the country we live in), or YouTube, Facebook and other video hosting services, our video consumption is through the roof, accounting for the vast majority of internet traffic across the globe anyway. Movie theatres have become more about the social experience for most, or for a few, it might still be about the big screen, big sound experience. The odd blockbuster movie that can only be experienced on the big screen still puts butts in seats in theatres, but the pandemic has reminded us all that we can easily do without them if they did indeed die out tomorrow.

SUPERHEROES (DID THEY KILL POP CULTURE?)

You can't talk about movies in 2020 and not talk about superheroes. No matter where you look you see them, and they're in merchandising, on the big screen, invading pop culture like Genghis Khan on steroids. People are already talking about suffering from superhero fatigue, or in simpler terms, being totally fed up of both Marvel and DC movies. The fad has been likened to the obsession the US had with wild west movies for a few decades in the last century. Eventually, we can hope it will blow over and we return to some sort of variety in movies and series.

Besides, the whole good vs evil fighting for control of the planet is just so lame a thought anyway. The concept that some people are inherently good and some evil is flawed, and more and more people are beginning to see that. There is a shift towards making characters more believable, and more human, which makes them both good and bad all at the same time, depending on what situation they're facing. This facing of reality that we all need to do is something superhero movies and comics have ruined over the years. They're really no different from all of the stories that exist in every ancient culture, because good vs evil or night vs day are concepts that are perhaps